

Earth Day heroes to be honored at park's tree-planting ceremony

By GAIL SMITH
Staff Writer

Next month, 11 bald cypress trees will be planted in the Greenville neighborhood park to honor the environmental heroes of Earth Day 1991.

"We're planting a grove of trees every year for the winners, because the trees help clean the air," said Barbara Webster, president of the Earth Coalition of Charlotte-Mecklenburg, which sponsored Earth Day.

"We just think it's a meaningful way to honor these people."

The tree-planting ceremony will be noon Dec. 20. A plaque also will be placed inside the Greenville neighborhood center, commemorating the planting and listing the names of the Earth Day heroes.

Last year, the coalition planted trees at the city's Cordelia Park.

"We're just going around the city looking for appropriate places for trees, and we're working with city people and letting them identify appropriate spots for trees," Webster said.

"That way the city gets trees, people get honored; it's a win-win situation."

The Blumenthal Foundation gave the coalition a grant specifically to honor the heroes, and the grant money pays for the plaques and the trees.

The bald cypress trees will be a pleasant addition to the Greenville park, Webster said.

"They are very distinctly shaped trees," she said. "There's no tree in the park quite like it, so it will make a real nice grow."

The trees planted next month



Barbara Webster

will honor the following people or organizations recognized at Earth Day 1991:

■ Oren McCullough, a retired mail carrier who recycles paper and cleans up his west Charlotte neighborhood.

■ Tecil Curlee, who has been composting for more than 35 years and donates his recycling proceeds to the Humane Society of Charlotte.

■ Deborah Sue Griffin, who was instrumental in starting the Carolina Raptor Center and has conducted educational programs at Camp Thunderbird's Environmental Education Center.

■ Lorraine Loke, who teaches children how to conserve drinking water as the Water Woman charac-

ter sponsored by the Charlotte-Mecklenburg Utility Department.

■ Ramsey Penegar, a Gaston County student who campaigned to rid the Gaston public school cafeterias of plastic and foam containers.

■ Thomas Huggins of the Lake Norman Yacht Club, who has been instrumental in encouraging proper disposal of foam dock-floatation materials and pressure-treated wood.

■ Dr. Jim Horton, chairman of the Mecklenburg County Environmental Protection Commission, who has pushed for the Mountain Island Lake watershed protection program.

■ Sierra Club Inner City Outings program, under the leadership of David Drum, Debbie Hubbard and Mara Malakoff, which encouraged a love of nature in more than 300 youngsters through hiking and camping, canoeing, nature games and other activities.

■ Douglas Edward Simpson, who started an aluminum-can recycling program and has contributed recycling proceeds to the Humane Society of Union County.

■ Scott Collins, who started UNC Charlotte's campuswide recycling program and helped the university reduce its aluminum can trash by 44%, or 4 tons, in a year. He also was Mecklenburg County's outstanding individual recycler for 1990.

■ Roy Alexander, who served on the first study group for recycling in Charlotte and has helped coordinate workshops, field trips and learning vacations with Science Museums of Charlotte.